Known NSA iOS/iPhone Exploit Timeline

2007 - 2008

Project DROPOUTJEEP

NSA builds comlete backdoor into iOS devices. Exploit is a modular system built to capture data off the device. Infiltration requires physical access / a wired connection.

2008

iPhone security update

Apple makes a massive security update to the iPhone platform involving hardware based encryption.

2010

More iPhone security updates

iPhone 4 included more encryption hardware, this time in order to protect encryption keys.

~2010 - 2013

CPU Signal reading attempts

Researchers developing exploits at Sandia attempt to break iPhone security by reading information off the CPU with probes. Project has some succeess.

~2013 - 2015

Project STRAWHORSE

NSA contractors find new attack vector - innocent iOS developers. Exploit is developed to infect Xcode 4.1 on developer machines and inject malicious code during compiliation. Project appears to be viable, real world usage unknown.